

The Standard Open Dialog

Pull down Teach's File menu and select "Open" to see an Open dialog. If you're running the program from the SystemTools2 disk, the dialog will look like the one in Figure 7A.

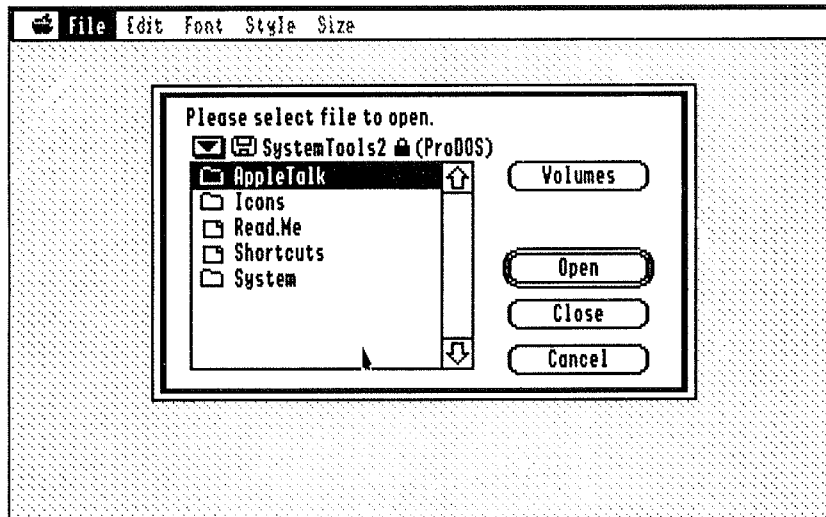


Figure 7A—Standard Open Dialog

At the top of the dialog, the program tells you what you're supposed to do—in this case, "Please select file to open." Each application can fill in this message—some are less formal. (We know of at least one program that simply asks "Whaddaya want?") Below this instructional message is an icon representing the disk you're using, the name of the disk, and its type: ProDOS, in our case. (There's also a padlock icon there if your disk is write-protected.)

The dialog is dominated by an alphabetical list of the files on the disk. The list will have a scroll bar if there are more files than will fit in the window. In the example, we're looking at the main SystemTools2 directory, which contains three folders and two documents.

Note!

Most Open dialogs show only the files that the program can open, along with folders. If you look at SystemTools2 with the Finder, you'll see that there are two applications (Teach and Archiver) in the main directory in addition to the documents. Teach doesn't show you those files in its Open dialog because Teach doesn't open applications; it opens text documents. The same thing would happen if there were graphics documents or other non-text documents on the disk; they, too, would not appear in Teach's Open dialog.